

Asia Insurance

Key takeaways from 2026 MDRT statistics: MDRT headcount resets, AIA still leads

We highlight one notable observation from the 2026 Million Dollar Round Table (MDRT) statistics: Asian insurers continue to dominate the global league table, accounting for 89% of the top 100, as shown in Figure 1. However, MDRT recognition declined meaningfully across many Asian insurers versus the previous two years, including AIA Group. In particular, MDRT headcount for AIA China and its India JV fell sharply by 73% and 51% oya in 2026, which surprised us. We do not view this as an immediate red flag. MDRT qualification was relaxed during COVID-19 and the threshold is now normalising, while many Asian life insurers have already surpassed their 2019 new life sales base. On a new business generation per headcount basis, we still see scope for agency productivity upside, particularly for AIA, FWD and Thai Life. Among these, we highlight AIA's favourable risk-reward, with the stock trading at 1.1x FY27E P/EV, or 12x FY27E P/OPAT, and offering a 4.7% total shareholder return yield. The stock has underperformed YTD, seemingly due to uncertainty around the HK MCV market ([link](#)). We believe AIA's 1H results in August could provide greater clarity, alongside continued double-digit growth momentum in key financial metrics.

- **MDRT decline looks more like normalisation than deterioration.** MDRT headcount declined during 2021/2022 due to the pandemic, but this is not surprising given the post-COVID normalisation of qualification criteria. We believe the comparison with 2019 is more relevant than the comparison with the relaxed COVID period. On this basis, MDRT trends for many multinational life insurers remain broadly healthy. Recent declines likely reflect higher qualification thresholds (Table 2), stricter protection mix requirements (i.e., only 12 markets are eligible to waive the requirement that at least 50% of qualifying products shall be from the risk-protection category; [link](#)), and reduced participation by Chinese insurers amid regulatory guidance discouraging MDRT recognition ([link](#)), as well as continued diversification into bancassurance.
- **AIA still leads the multinational MDRT league table.** AIA remains the clear leader among multinational insurers, with 16,228 MDRT members in 2026, exceeding the combined 14,856 members of UK Prudential, Manulife and US Prudential, as shown in Figure 3. While AIA's MDRT headcount declined by 73% and 51% in Mainland China and India markets respectively this year, the agency new business contribution has risen significantly by 15% oya (Figure 4). We therefore see the MDRT decline as a useful 1H results discussion point, rather than an immediate concern, with focus on agency productivity, headcount quality and margin delivery. Separately, while FWD has historically been positioned as a multi-distribution insurer, its agency channel execution also stands out. Its ranking among the leading MDRT cohorts is impressive, in our view, and points to strong execution capability in agency distribution.
- **MDRT remains a useful productivity proxy.** MDRT recognises highly productive life agents globally, based on minimum levels of premiums, commissions and income. Although insurers do not disclose productivity specifically for MDRT agents, our observation is that MDRT members tend to generate higher-margin and/or larger-ticket new life sales. A higher-quality MDRT base should therefore support stronger new business value and new business CSM additions, which are increasingly important for new business

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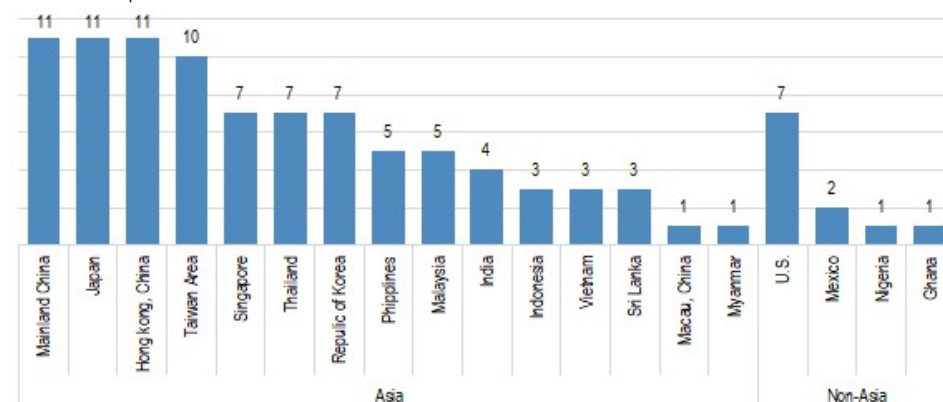
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economics and balance sheet growth under IFRS 17/9.

Figure 1: MDRT: Top 100 companies' geographic distribution in each market (2026)

Number of companies



Source: MDRT organisation. The aggregate number for each market only counts those companies among the top 100 rankings.

Table 1: MDRT: Number of MDRT agents across major multinational companies

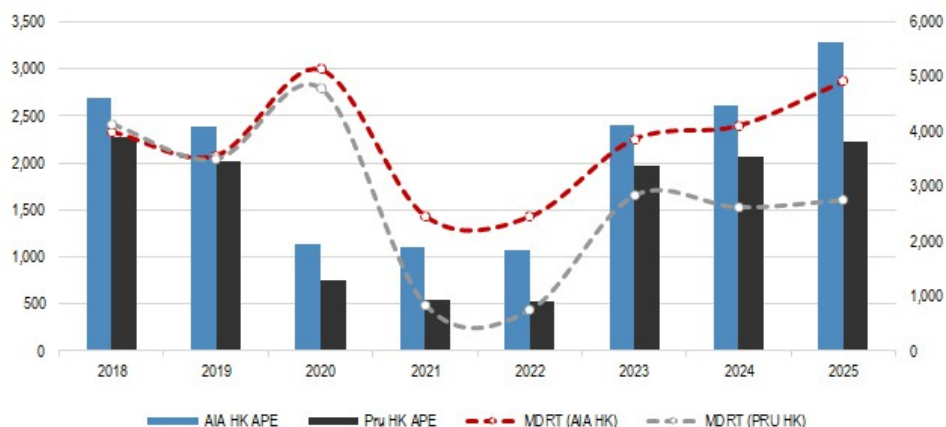
Number of people, %

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	Y/Y
AIA Group	12,438	12,796	16,017	15,745	15,579	18,750	19,358	16,228	-16%
AIA-China	2,577	2,687	3,283	4,255	3,674	4,656	3,892	1,063	-73%
AIA International (Hong Kong)	4,003	3,565	5,135	2,458	2,443	3,863	4,110	4,918	20%
AIA-Thailand	1,710	1,703	2,228	2,551	3,036	3,420	3,466	3,498	1%
AIA Vietnam	581	1,112	663	762	488	165	240	295	23%
AIA Bhd (Malaysia)	503	643	1,002	1,249	1,014	939	870	827	-5%
AIA Singapore Private Limited	570	593	1,141	1,240	1,380	1,449	1,920	2,104	10%
AIA-Macau	564	589	928	841	636	569	523	563	8%
Tata AIA Life-India	410	531	802	1,496	1,978	2,584	2,871	1,397	-51%
PT AIA Financial (Indonesia)	401	289	156	221	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.
AIA Life-Korea	181	170	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	224	301	34%
AIA Insurance Sri Lanka Limited	136	n.a.	213	216	n.a.	194	332	416	25%
Prudential Plc	6,675	6,524	11,578	6,993	6,971	9,065	7,571	7,472	-1%
Prudential Hong Kong Limited	4,142	3,503	4,790	850	743	2,836	2,623	2,751	5%
Prudential Japan life	1,258	1,316	2,083	1,675	1,596	1,660	1,643	1,702	4%
PT Prudential Life Assurance (Indonesia)	675	1,000	1,940	980	836	1,154	862	900	4%
Prudential Vietnam	595	560	1,524	1,245	1,976	1,522	546	229	-58%
Prudential Singapore	297	407	1,002	1,019	1,193	1,243	1,305	1,424	9%
CITIC Prudential Life	494	403	769	911	979	1,143	770	461	-40%
Prudential South Korea	333	368	465	309	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.
Prudential Assurance Malaysia Berhad	149	322	941	1,279	661	537	563	612	9%
FWD Group	575	1,026	1,545	2,225	2,131	2,089	1,842	1,702	-8%
FWD Life Hong Kong	406	546	625	562	388	565	602	706	17%
FWD Life Vietnam	169	216	485	790	701	429	304	n.a.	n.a.
FWD Life Philippines	-	-	-	330	352	358	391	398	2%
FWD Life Thailand	-	-	-	251	366	493	344	341	-1%

Source: MDRT. Note: the Group level number might not equal to the sum of individual subsidiaries as here we only have data for those ranking in the top 100 global companies. n.a. means the company is not among the top 100 rankings in a specific year.

Figure 2: Hong Kong Insurance: Number of MDRT agents vs. APE trend (RHS)

Number of people, US\$ in million (RHS)



Source: MDRT organisation, AIA Group and Prudential 2018-2024 annual reports.

Table 2: Asia: Requirements for membership in the 2026 Million Dollar Round Table (based on 2025 production)

Local currency

Method of production	Member ⁽¹⁾	COT ⁽²⁾	TOT ⁽³⁾	Method of production	Member ⁽¹⁾	COT ⁽²⁾	TOT ⁽³⁾
Mainland China (CNY)				Hong Kong, China (HKD)			
Commission	197,800	593,400	1,186,800	Commission	493,100	1,479,300	2,958,600
Income	489,500	1,468,500	2,937,000	Income	854,000	2,562,000	5,124,000
Premium	847,800	2,543,400	5,086,800	Premium	1,972,400	5,917,200	11,834,400
Japan (JPY)				Republic of Korea (KRW)			
Commission	8,360,800	25,082,400	50,164,800	Commission	70,703,500	212,110,500	424,221,000
Income	14,480,600	43,441,800	86,883,600	Income	122,455,500	367,366,500	734,733,000
Premium	25,082,400	75,247,200	150,494,400	Premium	176,758,750	530,276,250	1,060,552,500
India (INR)				Taiwan Area (TWD)			
Commission	1,132,600	3,397,800	6,795,600	Commission	1,389,600	4,168,800	8,337,600
Income	1,961,600	5,884,800	11,769,600	Income	2,406,800	7,220,400	14,440,800
Premium	4,530,400	13,591,200	27,182,400	Premium	2,779,200	8,337,600	16,675,200

Source: MDRT. Note: There are three tiers of MDRT membership including (1) Member: these are regular members who have satisfied the basic requirements, (2) Court of the Table (COT): these agents have achieved three times the amount indicated in the basic requirements, and (3) Top of the Table (TOT): these agents have achieved six times the amount indicated in the basic requirements. All amounts are expressed in local currency. Local currency divided by the conversion/standardization factor = MDRT requirement in US dollars. Please also note that each market may have individual specific requirements such as minimum amount requirements on new business and/or risk-based products in addition to commission/income/premium.

Table 3: Asia: Requirements for membership in the 2025 Million Dollar Round Table (based on 2024 production)

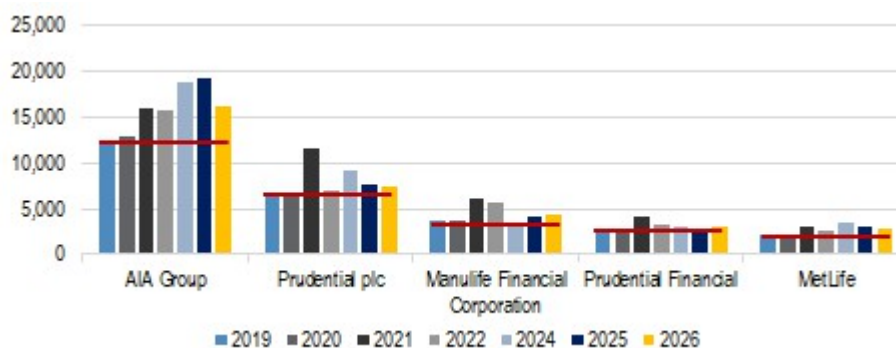
Local currency

Method of production	Member ⁽¹⁾	COT ⁽²⁾	TOT ⁽³⁾	Method of production	Member ⁽¹⁾	COT ⁽²⁾	TOT ⁽³⁾
Mainland China (CNY)				Hong Kong, China (HKD)			
Commission	245,700	737,100	1,474,200	Commission	471,300	1,413,900	2,827,800
Income	425,600	1,276,800	2,553,600	Income	816,200	2,448,600	4,897,200
Premium	737,100	2,211,300	4,422,600	Premium	1,885,200	5,655,600	11,311,200
Japan (JPY)				Republic of Korea (KRW)			
Commission	8,155,400	24,466,200	48,932,400	Commission	67,873,100	203,619,300	407,238,600
Income	14,124,900	42,374,700	84,749,400	Income	117,553,400	352,660,200	705,320,400
Premium	24,466,200	73,398,600	146,797,200	Premium	169,682,750	509,048,250	1,018,096,500
India (INR)				Taiwan Area (TWD)			
Commission	984,900	2,954,700	5,909,400	Commission	1,388,600	4,165,800	8,331,600
Income	1,705,800	5,117,400	10,234,800	Income	2,405,100	7,215,300	14,430,600
Premium	3,939,600	11,818,800	23,637,600	Premium	2,777,200	8,331,600	16,663,200

Source: MDRT. Note: There are three tiers of MDRT membership including (1) Member: these are regular members who have satisfied the basic requirements, (2) Court of the Table (COT): these agents have achieved three times the amount indicated in the basic requirements, and (3) Top of the Table (TOT): these agents have achieved six times the amount indicated in the basic requirements. All amounts are expressed in local currency. Local currency divided by the conversion/standardization factor = MDRT requirement in US dollars. Please also note that each market may have individual specific requirements such as minimum amount requirements on new business and/or risk-based products in addition to commission/income/premium.

Figure 3: MDRT: Number of MDRT members across the top 5 multinational companies

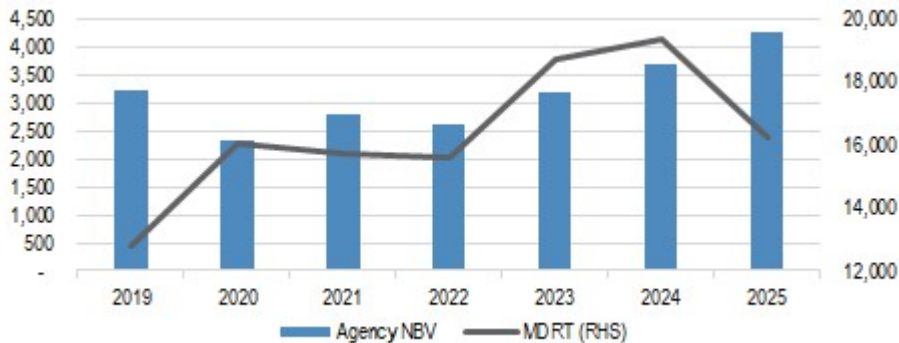
Number of people



Source: MDRT. Note: Top 5 multi-national rankings are based on 2019-2026 ranking data whilst 2023 data is unavailable.

Figure 4: AIA Group: Agency NBV trend vs. MDRT trend

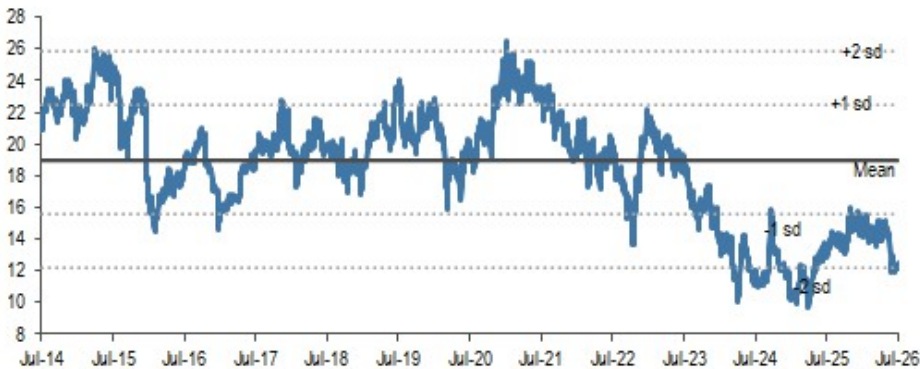
US\$ in million, Number of people (RHS)



Source: MDRT. AIA Group's annual report for 2019 to 2025. Note: MDRT number of current year is based on prior's year production, thus, individual year's MDRT figure is actually from next year's disclosed MDRT.

Figure 5: AIA Group: P/OPAT chart

x



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates. Data as of 14 July 2026.

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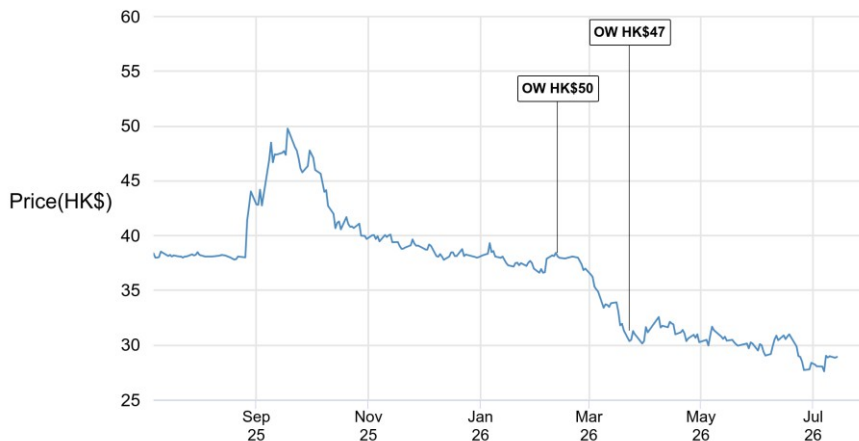
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Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
05-Aug-23	N	74.05	86
10-Aug-23	OW	71.70	86
07-Sep-23	OW	68.80	87
08-Feb-24	OW	63.20	92
22-Aug-24	OW	51.40	96
09-Oct-24	OW	64.70	102
04-Aug-25	OW	71.35	105
04-Nov-25	OW	79.95	107
29-Jan-26	OW	88.85	115
23-Mar-26	OW	86.05	112

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 01, 2010. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

FWD Group Holdings (1828.HK, 1828 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
12-Feb-26	OW	38.44	50
23-Mar-26	OW	31.34	47

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 12, 2026. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Thai Life Insurance (TLI.BK, TLI TB) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (Bt)	Price Target (Bt)
15-Nov-23	OW	10.10	19
29-Feb-24	OW	8.60	20
11-Jun-24	N	8.05	9
14-Aug-24	N	7.15	8
25-Sep-24	N	9.75	10.5
16-May-25	OW	11.00	15
23-Jan-26	OW	11.30	17.5

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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